

COVER YOU NEED BUT DIDN'T KNOW

Insurance is about as exciting as watching paint dry. But it's an essential financial tool—if you get the cover you need and not the one that's thrust upon you. **Priya Kapoor** hunts down five policies you might never have heard of even though some have existed for years. These are not for everyone, but if you have special needs or are prone to specific risks, you will do well to consider them.

DISABLED, NOT BROKE

Permanent or temporary disability—partial or total—can cripple you financially as well as physically and emotionally. It's worse if you are the sole breadwinner and are unable to work even for a few weeks or months. That's why you need an insurance policy that covers disability as well as death due to accidents. And there is one offered by most general insurers. As an income replacer, this policy is hard to beat. It costs as little as Rs 150 for every Rs 1 lakh of cover for disability and/or death due to an accident. In case of total disability due to an accident, you get the entire sum assured. In case of partial or temporary disability that prevents you from working, you get a weekly compensation for as long as you are away from work (subject to conditions). This cover is ideal for anyone with a hazardous job, and is also good for those who earn weekly wages, especially factory workers and those in the courier or delivery business.



TO YOUR NEWBORN'S HEALTH

The birth of a child is something almost everyone looks forward to, and it brings with it much joy and excitement. However, for parents of children with congenital defects, consanguineous couples, and those belonging to communities where congenital defects are common, the anticipated birth comes with its share of worries. Apart from the emotional trauma, there is the very real problem of being unable to meet the medical expenses of the baby. That's why companies like New India Assurance and United India Insurance offer the birthright insurance policy to pay for the baby's medical treatment. The policy covers congenital anomalies and disabilities (both temporary and permanent—total and partial) that set in within two years of birth. For a premium of Rs 1,500, you can get a cover of Rs 75,000.